
Part of the **Enactus 101 Guide Series** — global guides designed to help every team learn, lead, and create impact.



BUILDING AN ENACTUS TEAM TEAM STRUCTURE, LEADERSHIP & CULTURE

Developing a strong Enactus team.

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About the Enactus 101 Series

This guide is part of the Enactus 101 Series — a set of simple, practical guides designed to help you learn, lead, build projects, measure your impact, and grow as a changemaker. We encourage you to explore the full series throughout the year.



WHAT THIS GUIDE IS / IS NOT

What This Guide Gives You

- A practical resource to help you build a strong, sustainable, student-led Enactus team
- A blueprint for developing leaders, organising roles, and shaping culture
- A companion to Guide 1 (Welcome to Enactus) and a foundation for all other guides
- A global reference for new teams and growing teams

What This Guide Does Not Include

- A rulebook — you can adapt it to your university, culture, or team size
- A full project development guide (see Guide 3)
- A competition rulebook (see Guide 6)

Purpose: To help every Enactus team — new or established — create a structure where students thrive, projects succeed, and leadership grows year after year.

Contents of this Guide:

- The Anatomy of a High-Performing Enactus Team
- Mission, Vision & Values: Your Team's Foundation
- Your Student Team: Roles & Pathways
- Functional Support Roles
- Which Role Is Right For Me?
- Choosing The Right Team Structure
 - Team Structure Models | Project-centered
 - Team Structure Models | Functional pods
 - Team Structure Models | Hybrid team
- Team structure at-a-glance
- Building A Strong Team Culture
- Recruitment: Growing a Diverse, Motivated Team
- Recruitment: How To Recruit
- Recruitment That Inspires
- Enactus 101 Recruiting Tips
- Final Things to Consider





Research Insight (Schutter, 2025):

Across more than 100 Enactus teams, the strongest predictor of social, environmental, and financial success was internal team capacity — not funding, not faculty involvement, not university size. Team size, clarity, and continuity matter.



THE ANATOMY OF A HIGH-PERFORMING ENACTUS TEAM

Strong teams don't happen by accident. They are intentionally designed — with clarity, trust, shared leadership, and healthy rhythms.

High-performing teams share five elements:

1) Clear Purpose

Everyone knows why the team exists, what it is trying to achieve, and how it contributes to Enactus' global mission.

2) Defined Roles & Pathways

People understand their responsibilities and know how they can grow.

5) Continuity & Learning

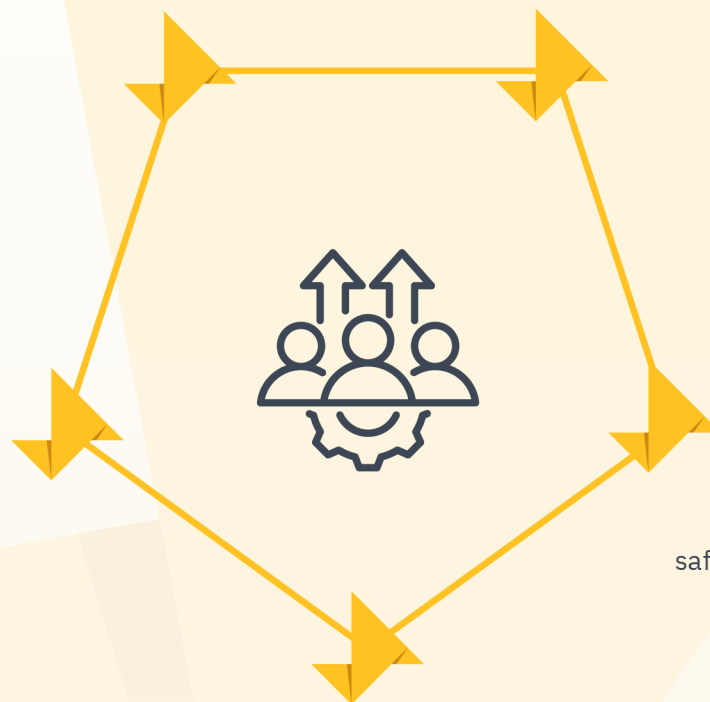
Knowledge is passed on; new leaders are developed before old ones leave.

3) Strong Culture

A sense of belonging, psychological safety, trust, and respect.

4) Rhythm & Structure

Regular meetings, check-ins, documentation, and clear workflows.



PURPOSE <> ROLES <> CULTURE <> SYSTEMS <> LEARNING

MISSION, VISION & VALUES: YOUR TEAM'S FOUNDATION

Every strong Enactus team is guided by a shared purpose — not just tasks or deadlines. Your mission, vision, and values shape your identity, your culture, and your long-term direction.

These aren't "nice to have" statements. They are how your team stays focused, aligned, and united.



YOUR MISSION — WHAT YOU DO EVERY DAY

Your mission explains why your team exists and what you commit to doing this year.

A strong mission:

- Is clear and short
- Focuses on action
- Reflects your identity as an Enactus team
- Helps new members understand what they're joining

Simple Formula:

"We [team action] to [create impact] through [approach]."

Examples:

- "We empower students to develop and launch sustainable, entrepreneurial solutions that improve lives."
- "We create positive impact in our community by combining innovation, teamwork, and entrepreneurial action."



YOUR VISION — THE FUTURE YOU WANT TO HELP BUILD

Your vision answers the question: "If our team succeeds over time, what could our campus or community look like?" Your vision is about possibility, not about tasks.

A strong vision:

- Is inspiring
- Looks beyond one year
- Connects to the future of your university or community
- Aligns with Enactus' global mission

Examples:

- "A campus where every student has the opportunity to lead positive change."
- "A community where sustainable, inclusive solutions are created by students and local partners together."
- "A generation of student leaders shaping a regenerative world."

“

Your mission, vision, and values are your team's compass. They help you decide where to go, how to move, and what to return to when things get difficult.

”

MISSION, VISION & VALUES: YOUR TEAM'S FOUNDATION



YOUR VALUES — HOW YOU WORK TOGETHER

Values guide your team when no one is watching. They shape your culture, your decisions, and your relationships.

Most Enactus teams base their values on the global Enactus principles:

- Integrity — act with honesty and transparency
- Passion — care deeply about people and impact
- Innovation — seek creative, practical solutions
- Collaboration — work across disciplines and cultures

Teams often add values that reflect local identity, such as: Empathy, Curiosity, Inclusivity, Responsibility, Courage.

HOW TO DEFINE YOUR MISSION, VISION & VALUES (STEP-BY-STEP)

Use this during your leadership retreat or first team meeting. *Ask the right questions:*

Mission questions:

- Why does our team exist?
- What do we want to do every week?
- How do we create impact through Enactus?

Vision questions:

- What do we hope will change because we exist?
- What future are we trying to help create?
- What does “success” look like in 2–3 years?

Values questions:

- What behaviours do we expect from each other?
- How do we want people to feel when they join our team?
- What matters to us when things get challenging?

ENACTUS TIPS:

For Crafting Strong Statements

- **Keep it short.** If you can't remember it, you won't live it.
- **Use simple words.** Clarity is more powerful than sophistication.
- **Make it active.** Use verbs — “empower,” “create,” “build,” “lead,” “collaborate,” “innovate.”
- **Let everyone contribute.** Mission, vision, and values feel real only if the whole team shapes them.
- **Review once a year.** Teams grow. Your purpose can grow too.

ENACTUS RECOMMENDATIONS:

Your mission, vision, and values guide:

- Your recruitment messages
- Your social media tone
- How you evaluate new project ideas
- How you make decisions
- How you collaborate as a team
- How you represent yourselves at competitions
- How you onboard new members

They are not posters — they are practice.

“

Your team is your learning community. A strong team blends different roles, strengths, and experiences.

”



YOUR STUDENT TEAM: ROLES & PATHWAYS



NEW MEMBERS

You bring fresh energy, skills, and perspective.

Your role is to:

- learn about Enactus and your team
- contribute to a project team
- help research, ideate, build, test, or communicate
- ask questions, be curious
- explore roles that fit your interests

Your next step:

Choose a project or role to deepen your learning.



EXPERIENCED MEMBERS

You carry team knowledge — and help shape culture and continuity.

You often take on roles such as:

- training new members
- managing project workstreams
- competition preparation
- impact measurement
- partnership relationships
- team operations

Your next step:

Consider becoming a Project Leader or Functional Lead.



TEAM LEADERS (PRESIDENT / CO-LEADS)

You guide strategy, culture, communication, and accountability across the whole team.

Your core responsibilities:

- align the team around mission, vision, and values
- run leadership meetings and full-team meetings
- support Project Leaders and coordinate across all projects
- manage communication with your Faculty Advisor and Country Office
- maintain team structure, documentation, and continuity
- lead recruitment and leadership succession

What makes a great Team Leader in Enactus:

Not doing everything — but ensuring everything has someone who owns it.



PROJECT LEADER

You guide the success, learning, and impact of a single project.

You manage:

- stakeholder engagement and community partnerships
- research, ideation, prototyping, and testing
- project planning, timelines, and task coordination
- team communication and collaboration
- impact measurement and documentation
- preparing your project story for competitions and partners

This is one of the most transformative student leadership roles in Enactus.

“

Functional support roles help your team operate smoothly, stay organized, and grow sustainably. They are essential for strong teams and scalable projects.

”

FUNCTIONAL SUPPORT ROLES



Impact & Data Lead

- supports project teams with surveys, indicators, and measurement
- documents outcomes for competitions and partners
- maintains your team's impact dashboard



Finance & Admin Lead

- supports project teams with surveys, indicators, and measurement
- documents outcomes for competitions and partners
- maintains your team's impact dashboard



Communications Lead

- manages social media and team storytelling
- creates consistent branding for updates, pitches, and events
- captures photos, videos, and stories from project activities



Partnerships & Sponsorship Lead

- maintains relationships with community partners
- assists with sponsorship outreach and small funding streams
- liaises with the university or student union when needed



Membership & Wellbeing Lead

- coordinates recruitment and onboarding
- supports team culture, wellbeing, and inclusion
- runs social activities and recognition moments

ENACTUS TIPS

More teams are adding new types of roles to their team structures, such as:

- **Innovation Lead** - Supports design thinking, ideation sessions, and creative problem-solving.
- **Sustainability Lead** - Helps ensure projects align with SDGs, ethical practices, and long-term viability.
- **Partnership Engagement Liaison** - Coordinates communication with NGOs, startups, city offices, and experts.

Go out there, research and speak with successful social entrepreneurs or social impact organisations: what makes their teams thrive?

“

Functional support roles help your team operate smoothly, stay organized, and grow sustainably. They are essential for strong teams and scalable projects.

”



WHICH ROLE IS RIGHT FOR ME?

A quick role selector for new and returning members.

→ **Do you enjoy organizing people, decisions, or big-picture thinking?**

Consider: Team Leader, Project Leader, Operations Lead.

→ **Do you like researching problems or understanding community needs?**

Consider: Impact & Data Lead, Community Insights Lead, Sustainability Lead.

→ **Do you enjoy creating things — designing, prototyping, experimenting?**

Consider: Innovation Lead, Project Workstream Lead, Prototyping Lead.

→ **Do you love writing, visuals, or digital storytelling?**

Consider: Communications Lead, Storytelling Lead, Content Creator.

→ **Do you like talking to people, networking, or managing relationships?**

Consider: Partnerships Lead, Sponsorship Lead, Community Liaison.

→ **Do you enjoy supporting people, wellbeing, or team culture?**

Consider: Membership & Wellbeing Lead.

→ **Do you like structure, numbers, or keeping things organized?**

Consider: Finance & Admin Lead, Operations Lead.

→ **Do you like structure, numbers, or keeping things organized?**

Consider: Finance & Admin Lead, Operations Lead.



CHOOSING THE RIGHT TEAM STRUCTURE

Your team structure is not just an organisational chart — it's the system that shapes how you collaborate, innovate, and deliver impact.

Across the global Enactus network, top-performing teams use a structure that matches their size, experience, and number of projects. Strong structures help new members contribute faster, support continuity from year to year, and make projects more resilient and impactful.

Why structure matters?

A 2025 Utrecht University study on student social enterprises found that:

- **Internal team capacity** — not university funding or external support — is the strongest predictor of social, environmental, financial, and long-term success.
- **Larger, well-organised teams performed significantly better**, because they distributed leadership, avoided bottlenecks, and maintained continuity.
- **Teams with clear roles** (e.g., impact, partnerships, communications) produced higher-quality impact measurement and stronger project sustainability.
- **Collaboration-focused structures** had better community engagement outcomes.

This means:

Your structure shapes your impact. Choosing the right one matters.

ENACTUS TIPS

Learn from teams who are already doing it well.

- Research top Enactus teams in your country and globally. Reach out, ask questions, and learn how they structure roles and leadership.
- Follow teams on social media — many share behind-the-scenes structure, recruitment ideas, and leadership practices.
- Look at modern team design models like Pods/Squads (Spotify), IDEO.org project teams, and Ashoka Youth Ventures for inspiration.
- Study how social enterprises organise partnerships, impact, and innovation — these models translate directly to Enactus.
- Improve your structure yearly based on what your team needs now.

Strong teams learn from strong teams — and adapt continuously.





Every Enactus team looks different. Choose a structure that fits who you are now — and review it regularly to make sure it still supports your goals as your team grows and evolves.



TEAM STRUCTURE MODELS | PROJECT-CENTERED

MODEL A | PROJECT-CENTERED TEAM

Best for: medium-sized teams (15-35 members) or teams running 1–3 projects

Real-world parallel: Social enterprises with a “portfolio of ventures”

Example: “A team running three social ventures (agriculture, education, and circular economy) with 20 members.”

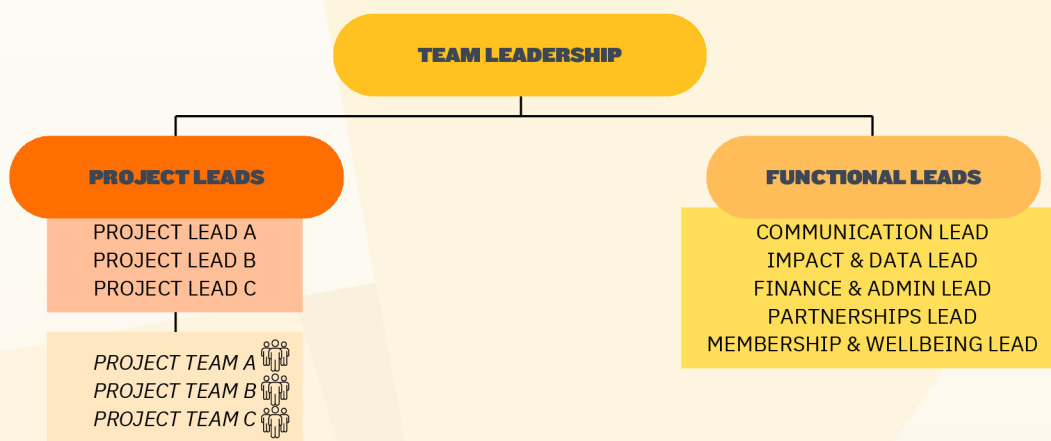
How it works

- Team Leaders guide strategy, culture, and communication
- Project Leaders run one project each
- Functional Leads support ALL projects (Impact & Data, Comms, Partnerships, Finance, Membership)
- Project Teams do the day-to-day work

Why choose this model

- ✓ clear accountability
- ✓ strong ownership
- ✓ easy to onboard new members
- ✓ great for teams focused on project excellence

Model A works best when projects need clear ownership and teams benefit from shared functional support.



ENACTUS TIPS

15 - 35 members is the most common Enactus team size globally. *This teamsize is ideal for:*

- 1–3 projects running in parallel
- clearly defined roles
- emerging leadership pathways

Characteristics:

- strong project ownership
- enough capacity to have functional leads
- great fit for the **Project-Centered Model**

SPACE FOR NOTES:

TEAM STRUCTURE MODELS | FUNCTIONAL PODS

MODEL B – FUNCTIONAL PODS (“SQUADS”)

Best for: small teams, new teams, or teams with one flagship project

Real-world parallel: Agile product teams (Spotify Model, IDEO.org)

How it works

Pods carry combined responsibilities:

- Impact Pod: impact measurement, beneficiary insights, field research
- Innovation Pod: prototyping, design, sustainability
- Communications Pod: branding, storytelling, social media
- Partnerships Pod: sponsors, grants, community relationships
- Operations Pod: admin, budgets, logistics

Students join pods based on interest and rotate into project tasks.

Why choose this model

- ✓ highly collaborative
- ✓ simple for new teams
- ✓ supports rapid experimentation
- ✓ ideal for teams building skills while figuring out their identity



Pods support ALL projects — students rotate into project tasks.

ENACTUS TIPS

5 - 15 members is often what teams start off with. It feels like a start-up and everyone wears multiple hats. *This teamsize is ideal for:*

- new teams
- teams rebuilding
- teams running 1 project

Characteristics:

- everyone wears multiple hats
- flexible informal roles
- good for the **Pods/Squad Model**

TEAM STRUCTURE MODELS | HYBRID TEAM

MODEL C – HYBRID TEAM STRUCTURE

Suggested for: large teams or high-performing teams with multiple projects

Real-world parallel: Matrix organisations used by global NGOs & social innovation hubs

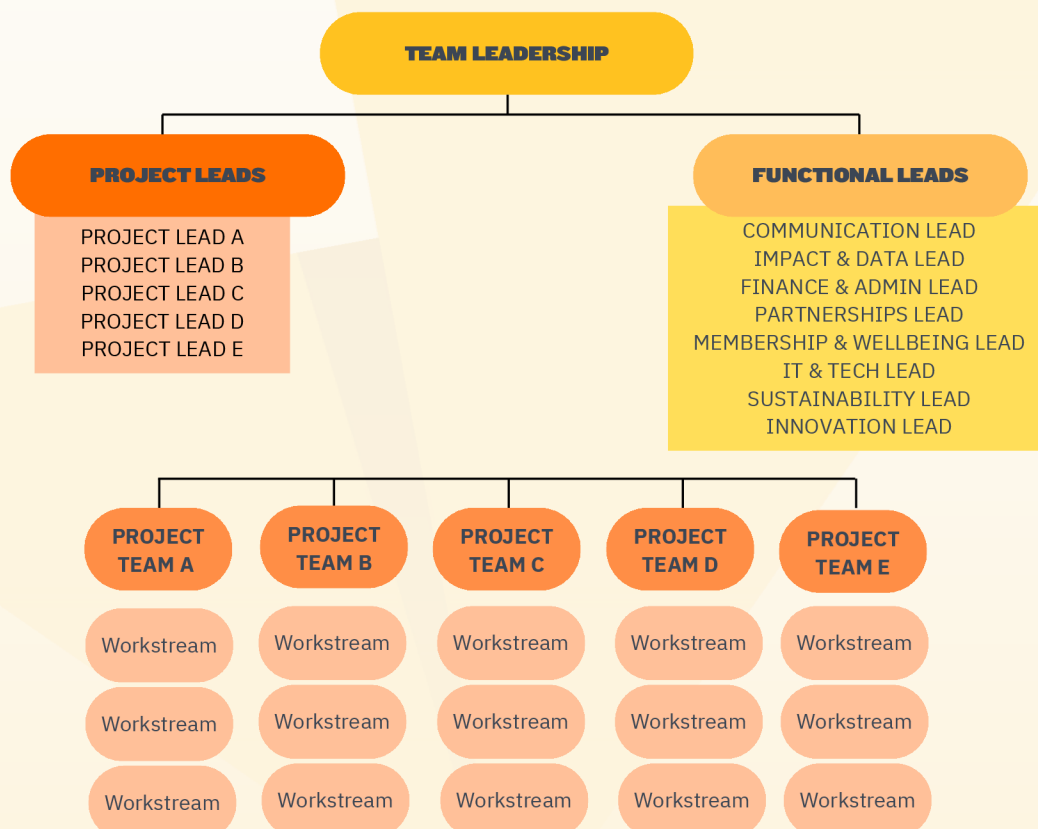
How it works

- Team Leaders manage vision, culture, continuity
- Functional Leads oversee organisation-wide systems
- Project Leaders run projects
- Workstream Leads support Project Leaders by managing specific areas, such as:
 - Prototyping
 - Community engagement
 - Impact measurement
 - Sustainability
 - Storytelling

Why choose this model

- ✓ scalable
- ✓ excellent for teams with several mature projects
- ✓ allows team experts to develop deep skills
- ✓ mirrors real-world social enterprise environments

Model C works best when your team is growing, projects are becoming more complex, and you need a scalable structure that mirrors real social-enterprise teams.



SPACE FOR NOTES:

TEAM STRUCTURE AT-A-GLANCE

Your team structure should make your work easier, not harder. Use this overview to understand the strengths of each model and choose the one that supports your mission, your people, and your projects.

FEATURE	MODEL A	MODEL B	MODEL C
Best for	Medium teams	Small teams	Large teams
Project ownership	High	Shared	High
Collaboration	Moderate	Very high	High
Onboarding ease	High	Moderate	High
Skills growth	Focused	Broad	Deep
Team continuity	High	Moderate	Very high

ENACTUS TIPS

How to Choose the Right Structure for Your Team

Ask yourselves:

- How many active members do we have?
- How many projects can we realistically support?
- Which roles do people naturally gravitate toward?
- How much continuity do we have year to year?
- Which model best supports our mission right now?

Your structure is a tool — not an identity.

It should make your work easier, clearer, and more sustainable.



“**Culture is how your team behaves when no one is watching. It shapes motivation, trust, creativity, and long-term success — especially in student-run social ventures where leadership changes every year.**”



BUILDING A STRONG TEAM CULTURE

A strong Enactus team culture is built intentionally through a sense of purpose & belonging, clarity, safety, and shared systems.

CREATE PURPOSE & BELONGING

People stay when they understand why the team exists and feel they have a meaningful place within it.

- make sure every new member understands your mission and how their work contributes
- pair newcomers with a peer-mentor or “go-to person” for questions
- design socials or meetups that help people connect across roles and backgrounds
- highlight progress regularly: learning milestones, insights gained, partner feedback, early impact — not just big wins

Insight: Purpose + belonging is one of the strongest predictors of long-term engagement in student innovation and entrepreneurship teams.

BUILD PSYCHOLOGICAL SAFETY

Innovation grows when people feel safe to question, contribute, experiment — and learn from what doesn’t work.

- make it normal to ask anything (no question is “too basic”)
- use balanced voice norms: everyone speaks once before anyone speaks twice
- brainstorm with “yes-and” to expand ideas rather than shut them down
- treat mistakes and failed tests as data, not performance judgment
- use simple check-ins (red / yellow / green) to understand team energy and wellbeing

Insight: Studies report significantly better outcomes in creativity, collaboration, and impact when team members feel safe to speak up, experiment, and learn from mistakes.

ESTABLISH A TEAM RHYTHM (HOW YOU WORK TOGETHER)

A clear rhythm of collaboration gives your team stability, momentum, and shared expectations — especially important in student teams with changing membership.

- Weekly team meetings with a focused agenda and clear outcomes
- Bi-weekly project check-ins to track progress and unblock challenges
- Monthly learning or reflection sessions to capture insights and improve
- Quarterly impact reviews to assess results and realign goals
- Annual vision or planning day to set direction for the next cycle
- Short asynchronous updates via Slack, WhatsApp, or other tools to stay aligned between meetings

Insight: Consistent team rhythms reduce cognitive load, prevent miscommunication and help teams stay coordinated during high-pressure academic periods.

Document Everything (Your Team’s Collective Memory)

Strong teams don’t rely on memory — they build systems. Use simple, accessible tools: Google Drive / Notion / Airtable / OneDrive / Slack channels

Document:

- project plans + progress
- meeting notes + decisions
- partnerships + community contacts
- impact measurement data
- templates (surveys, budgets, reports)
- handover materials for new leaders

Insight: The #1 reason student teams collapse is knowledge disappearing when leaders graduate. Documentation protects your continuity — and your impact

SPACE FOR NOTES:

RECRUITMENT: GROWING A DIVERSE, MOTIVATED TEAM

Recruitment is more than getting people to join — it's how you shape the future of your team. Who you bring in determines your capacity, your culture, and the type of impact your team can create.

WHY RECRUITMENT MATTERS

Your recruitment strategy determines:

- the skills and energy your team has for the whole year
- whether your team can run meaningful projects
- whether leadership burnout increases or decreases
- how inclusive, creative, and resilient your team becomes
- how many members stay active throughout the year

Strong recruitment = strong teams.

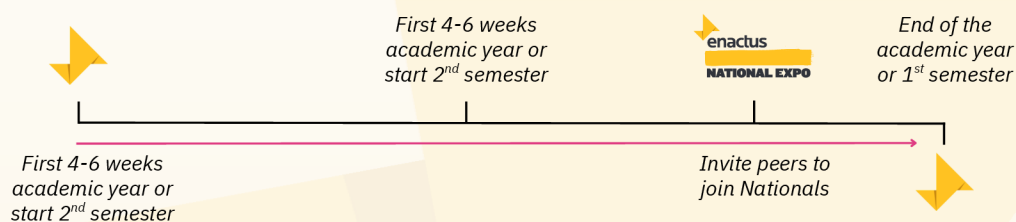
Weak recruitment = fragile teams, overwhelmed leaders, and stalled projects.

WHEN TO RECRUIT (AND WHEN NOT TO)

Recruitment should happen with intention and timing, not randomly.

Best Times to Recruit (timeline dependent on start academic year in country)

- Start of academic year (first 4–6 weeks)
- After major events (project showcases, competitions, impact days)
- At semester shift (when students reset their schedules)



Avoid recruiting:

- during exam periods
- right before competitions (people join but can't meaningfully contribute)
- when the team is too overwhelmed to onboard properly

TIP

👉 Only recruit when you're ready to onboard well.



SPACE FOR NOTES:

RECRUITMENT: HOW TO RECRUIT

WHO YOU ARE RECRUITING FOR?

You are looking for people who bring:

- curiosity and willingness to learn
- commitment to purpose
- empathy for community partners
- problem-solving mindset
- skills that complement your current team (not copy it)
- diversity of backgrounds and perspectives

You are not looking for perfect people. You're looking for people who want to try, grow, and contribute.



ENACTUS TIPS

Avoid the Biggest Recruitment Pitfall: “Your Own Bubble”

It's easy for teams to accidentally recruit people who:

- look like them
- study the same subject
- come from the same friend groups
- already share the same worldview

This leads to groupthink, fewer ideas, limited creativity, and weaker real-world problem-solving.

What strong teams do instead:

- recruit across multiple faculties
- actively invite underrepresented groups
- use open language (“no experience required”)
- make events accessible for introverts, commuters, international students
- highlight diverse pathways: tech, comms, impact, partnerships, design, sustainability

Diversity isn't a slogan — it's a performance advantage. Mixed-background teams consistently produce more innovative and more sustainable project solutions.

“Recruitment gives your team the opportunity to inspire peers to join on an experiential learning journey. It’s the moment students discover that they can belong to something bigger — a team with purpose, possibility, and a way to create real impact.”



RECRUITMENT THAT INSPIRES

The most successful teams recruit intentionally and inclusively, reaching students who want to learn, lead, and join a movement focused on regeneration.

Your recruitment is not just marketing. It’s an invitation to join a global movement of students rebuilding the future.

BEST CHANNELS TO REACH STUDENTS

Use a combination of digital reach and human connection — this is where modern student recruitment thrives.

Digital Channels

- Short-form social media: Reels, TikTok, YouTube Shorts
- Instagram/TikTok takeovers by real members
- “Meet the Team” or “Day in the Life” micro-stories
- QR codes linking to sign-ups, project videos, or a join form

On-Campus Channels

- Classroom shoutouts (business, environment, engineering, design, agriculture, social sciences — anywhere your challenges live)
- Booths in high-traffic areas (library corridor, cafeteria)
- Impact showcases — highlight your project prototypes, stories, or a simple “Before/After Impact” wall
- Collaborations with other societies (student union, entrepreneurship hub, engineering groups)
- Enactus Ambassadors: real students from your team sharing their authentic experience

Tip: Ask your Enactus Country Office for Enactus & Gen:Re branding assets to make your materials look world-class.

INSIGHTS: WHAT STUDENTS CARE ABOUT MOST

Across all Enactus countries, students consistently join because they want:

Purpose

“I want to work on something meaningful, not just theoretical.”

Community

“I want to belong somewhere. I want to be around good people.”

Skills & Growth

“I want real experience that helps me grow personally and professionally.”

Opportunities

“I want chances to lead, network, compete, and access future careers.”

Visible Impact

“I want to see results — something real that I helped create.”

Your recruitment should speak directly to these motivations.

ENACTUS TIPS

Messaging that works

- Turn ideas into real impact.”
- “Build skills employers love — while helping your community.”
- “Join a global network of young changemakers.”
- “Solve real problems with real people.”
- “No experience required — you learn as you go.”
- “Be part of Gen:Re — Generation Regeneration.”

ENACTUS 101 RECRUITING TIPS



RECRUIT ACROSS DISCIPLINES

A strong Enactus team reflects many academic fields:

- Business → model & strategy
- Engineering → prototypes
- Literature, Arts & Design → storytelling
- Social Sciences → community insight
- Agriculture / Health / Environment → technical expertise



RECRUIT FOR VALUES, NOT JUST SKILLS

skills can be taught. Values shape your culture. Look for:

- empathy
- adaptability
- reliability
- creativity
- curiosity
- initiative



RECRUIT FOR COMMITMENT

Be honest about the work — teams thrive when expectations are clear.

ENACTUS TIPS

Recruiting Do / Don't

DO:

- ✓ recruit across faculties
- ✓ highlight purpose & growth
- ✓ show real members and real projects
- ✓ make it easy for people to try a first meeting

DON'T:

- ✗ recruit only friends
- ✗ overwhelm new members
- ✗ use academic jargon
- ✗ rely only on posters or social media



FINAL THINGS TO CONSIDER

Three essentials that make good teams great? Leadership Continuity, Communication, & Team Agreements

I. LEADERSHIP SUCCESSION & HANDOVER

A strong team plans for next year long before the current year ends.

Why it matters

- Leadership transition is one of the biggest risks for student teams.
- Knowledge disappears when graduating leaders take it with them.
- Continuity protects your projects, your partners, and your culture.

How to do it

- Start early (e.g. Feb–April when starting year in Sep): identify who's ready to grow.
- Shadowing: pair next-year leaders with current leaders for 4–6 weeks.
- Document everything—use Google Drive/Notion/Airtable for:
 - project files
 - partner contacts
 - budgets
 - impact data
 - competition materials
 - passwords & accounts
- Host a handover session: goals, lessons learned, expectations.
- Leave a “first 30 days” checklist for your successor.

Insight: Teams with strong succession planning are more likely to sustain long-term, impactful projects

2. HEALTHY COMMUNICATION & CONFLICT TOOLS

Great teams don't avoid conflict — they handle it well.

Why this matters

Projects, deadlines, and different personalities will create friction. That's normal. How you respond determines team strength.

Simple tools that work

- Team agreements (how we communicate, make decisions, and support each other)
- SBI feedback
 - Situation — Behavior — Impact
 - Keeps feedback clear, not personal.
- Weekly check-ins
 - “How's everyone doing?”
 - “What's blocking progress?”
- “Everyone speaks once before anyone speaks twice”
 - Builds inclusion and reduces dominance.
- Assume positive intent
 - People usually want to help — not harm.
- Seek help early
 - If something feels too big, involve your Team Leader or Faculty Advisor.

Insight: Teams with strong communication practices show better collaboration and significantly higher project completion rates

“ This one-page agreement helps your team stay aligned, reduce confusion, and work well together – especially as new members join. Complete it together at the start of the year and review it twice annually. ”



FINAL THINGS TO CONSIDER

HOW WE WORK TOGETHER

A shared compass for clarity, collaboration, and a strong team culture.

TEAM AGREEMENT TEMPLATE

1. MEETINGS - Our Rhythm

How often we meet

☐ Weekly ☐ Bi-weekly ☐ Other: _____

Length of meetings

☐ 45 min ☐ 60 min ☐ 90 min ☐ Other: _____

Our meeting norms

(e.g., agendas, start/finish on time, cameras on/off, note-taking)

→ _____
→ _____

Preparation expectations (e.g., read agenda, bring updates, review project tasks)

→ _____

2. COMMUNICATION – Our Channels & Expectations

Where we communicate

Primary platform(s): ☐ WhatsApp ☐ Discord ☐ Slack ☐ Email

Other: _____

Response time expectations

(e.g., 24 hours on weekdays, slower during exams)

→ _____

Which channels for what?

Quick updates → _____

Deep work / documents → _____

Urgent issues → _____

3. DECISION-MAKING – How We Decide

Our primary decision method

- ☐ Consensus
☐ Majority vote
☐ Team Leader decision after consultation
☐ Depends on situation (explain):

→ _____

When we escalate decisions

(e.g., to Team Leader, Faculty Advisor)

→ _____



This one-page agreement helps your team stay aligned, reduce confusion, and work well together — especially as new members join. Complete it together at the start of the year and review it twice annually.



FINAL THINGS TO CONSIDER

HOW WE WORK TOGETHER

A shared compass for clarity, collaboration, and a strong team culture.

TEAM AGREEMENT TEMPLATE | PAGE 2

4. WORKLOAD & WELLBEING — How We Support Each Other

What to do if someone feels overwhelmed

→ _____
→ _____

Contribution expectations

(e.g., hours/week, taking on roles, completing tasks)

→ _____

How we support each other during busy seasons (exams, competition prep, deadlines)

→ _____

5. INCLUSION — How We Make Everyone Feel Part of the Team

How we ensure all voices are heard (e.g., “speak once before anyone speaks twice,” round-robins)

→ _____

How we welcome new members (onboarding, buddies, intro meetings, socials)

→ _____

Our norms for respectful collaboration

→ _____
→ _____

Sign-Off (Optional)

These are our shared commitments. We agree to revisit and improve them together.

Team Name: _____

Date Created: _____

Next Review: _____

Signatures (optional):

→ _____
→ _____
→ _____

FINAL THOUGHTS

Building an Enactus team is not just about structures, roles, or processes — it’s about people coming together with purpose. When you align around a clear mission, create simple systems, and support each other’s growth, your team becomes a place where ideas turn into impact and students become leaders. **Remember: have fun along the way.** The most powerful Enactus teams enjoy working together, celebrate progress, and find joy in changing lives — including their own.

About the Enactus 101 Series

This guide is part of the Enactus 101 Series — a set of simple, practical guides designed to help you learn, lead, build projects, measure your impact, and grow as a changemaker. We encourage you to explore the full series throughout the year.



THE ENACTUS 101 GUIDE SERIES (OVERVIEW PAGE)

Guide 1 — Welcome to Enactus & Your Impact Journey

The essential starting guide for all students. Introduces the Enactus mission, the Enactus Impact Journey Roadmap, core values, culture, and what it means to be an Enactus social innovator.

Guide 2 — Building an Enactus Team (Team Structure, Culture & Leadership)

How to build and lead a strong Enactus team. Includes team roles, leadership development, recruitment, culture-building, communication, conflict resolution, and running an effective student organization.

Guide 3 — Project Development & the Enactus Criterion

Your complete guide to designing strong Enactus projects. Covers research, systems thinking, human-centered design, community engagement, ideation, prototyping, the Enactus Criterion, and the Enactus Social Business Canvas.

Guide 4 — Measuring Impact (Data, Storytelling & Reporting)

How to measure, understand, and communicate your project impact. Includes impact definitions, theory of change, surveys, dashboards, storytelling basics, and how to prepare for annual data reporting.

Guide 5 — Preparing for Competitions (Nationals & World Cup)

Everything students need to succeed in competition. Covers storytelling strategy, presentation logic, project evidence, Impact & Financial Review expectations, evaluation forms and the judging role.

Guide 6 — Working with Partners & Advisors

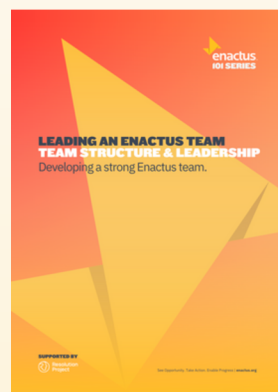
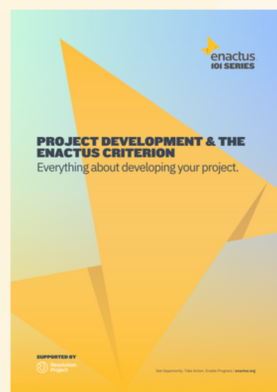
How to build and manage strong partnerships. Includes engaging Faculty Advisors, activating Business Advisory Clusters, securing institutional support, collaborating with external partners, and ethical partnership practices.

Guide 7 — Faculty Advisor Guide

A practical support guide for educators. Provides tools for mentorship, academic integration, student development, project coaching, and navigating Enactus competitions and programs.

Guide 8 — Tools & Exercises for Enactus Teams

A practical resource for students and teams. Includes worksheets, exercises, and facilitation tools such as needs assessment activities, systems maps, ideation prompts, prototyping tools, impact measurement checklists, and team culture exercises.



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